

Nykaa App

A UX Exploration — Finding an Under-Eye Gel

Product Management — Assignment 1 | Airtribe

Goal & Methodology

- **GOAL**

Find and buy an under-eye gel by Depiwhite — and specifically check reviews relevant to dry skin before purchasing.

- **WHY THIS GOAL**

A brand + concern-driven task forces the app to prove itself across search, filtering, review discovery, and checkout — not just passive browsing.

- **METHOD**

A live, end-to-end session logged step-by-step from first app open through order confirmation, cross-checked against public reviews and two real-user conversations.

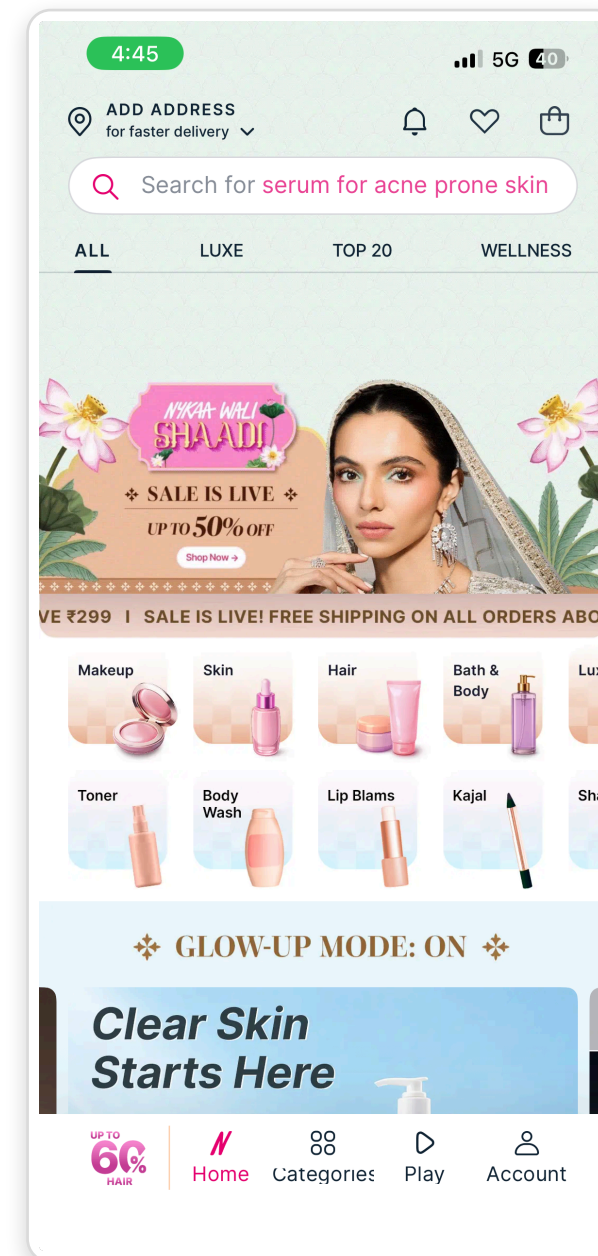
! FRUSTRATING EXPERIENCE

Fragmented Across Nykaa, Nykaa Fashion & Nykaa Man

Before the goal could even begin, the first obstacle was figuring out which app to open. Nykaa runs separate standalone apps for beauty, fashion, and men's grooming, with no outside signal telling a user which one carries skincare. This confusion resurfaced later too — the Account section of the beauty app actively promotes the sister apps, meaning the split isn't a one-time decision but ongoing overhead.

SUGGESTED FIX

Consolidate Nykaa, Nykaa Fashion, and Nykaa Man into a single app with a category switcher — or, short of a full merge, make the split obvious before download (e.g. clearer Play Store naming/icons) rather than leaving users to discover it by trial and error.



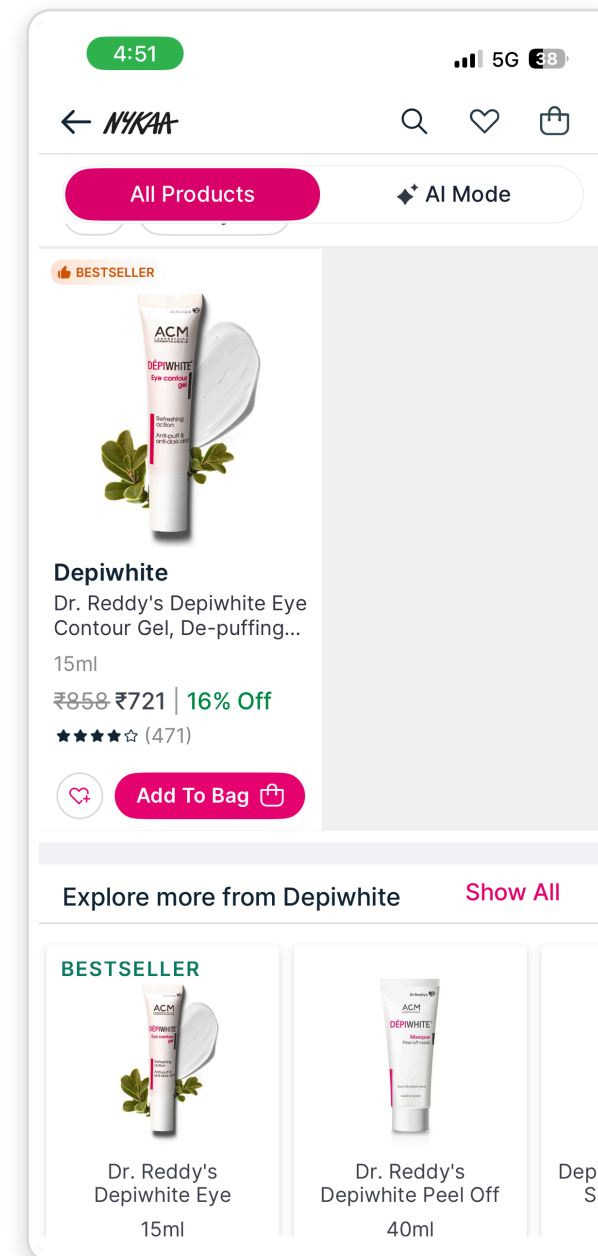
Home screen after finally landing in the right app

Generic Search Buries Relevant, Bestselling Products

The search bar's AI-style placeholder (“Search for serum for acne prone skin”) suggests concern-based search is a core feature. In practice, searching “under eye gel” or “under eye cream” did not surface Depiwhite Eye Contour Gel within several scrolls — despite it being a ranked bestseller (#18 under Top 20) and despite a rich filter panel (concern, composition, skin type, formulation, country of origin) being available. Searching the exact brand name, by contrast, surfaced it instantly with full pricing and rating.

SUGGESTED FIX

Weight bestseller/highly-rated products higher in concern-based search results, or surface the filter panel proactively when a broad query returns a large result set, rather than leaving discovery entirely to manual scrolling.





FRUSTRATING EXPERIENCE

A Review Filter That Isn't Actually a Filter

Wanting reviews relevant to dry skin, the “Beauty Traits” filter chip looked like the answer. Tapping it revealed filtering is gated behind creating a full public Beauty Portfolio — a multi-screen profile (skin type, concerns, hair, tone, undertone). Completing it to 100% still didn't filter anything: it's a social profile shown to other shoppers, not a private search tool. A second attempt triggered another permission prompt and redirected into unrelated product suggestions.

WHAT ACTUALLY WORKED

A separate, simple “Common Concerns” filter (predefined tags like “Long Term Results”) filtered reviews instantly — but it was two dead-end detours away from where it should have been the first, most visible option.

The screenshot shows a mobile app interface titled "Beauty Portfolio". At the top, there's a status bar with the time 5:01, 5G signal, and battery level. Below the title, a subtitle says "Update your attributes at any time". There are three green buttons with checkmarks: "Skin", "Hair", and "Makeup". A pink progress bar indicates "100% complete". Below this is an "Attribute Summary" section with a chevron icon. The summary text states: "Attributes will be shown to other shoppers on your reviews, and you can view others' attributes". A "Customize" link is present. Below is a list of attributes with icons and toggle switches:

- Skin Type: **Combination** ☐
- Skin Concern: **Tanning, Dull Skin, Dark Spots & Pigmentation** ☐
- Hair Concern: **Hairfall & Thinning** ☐
- Hair Type: **Straight** ☐
- Scalp Type: **Balanced** ☐
- Skin Tone: **Medium Dark** ☐
- Undertone: **Warm** ☐

At the bottom of the list is a "Save preferences" button. Below the list is a navigation bar with three tabs: "Skin" (highlighted with a pink underline), "Hair", and "Makeup".

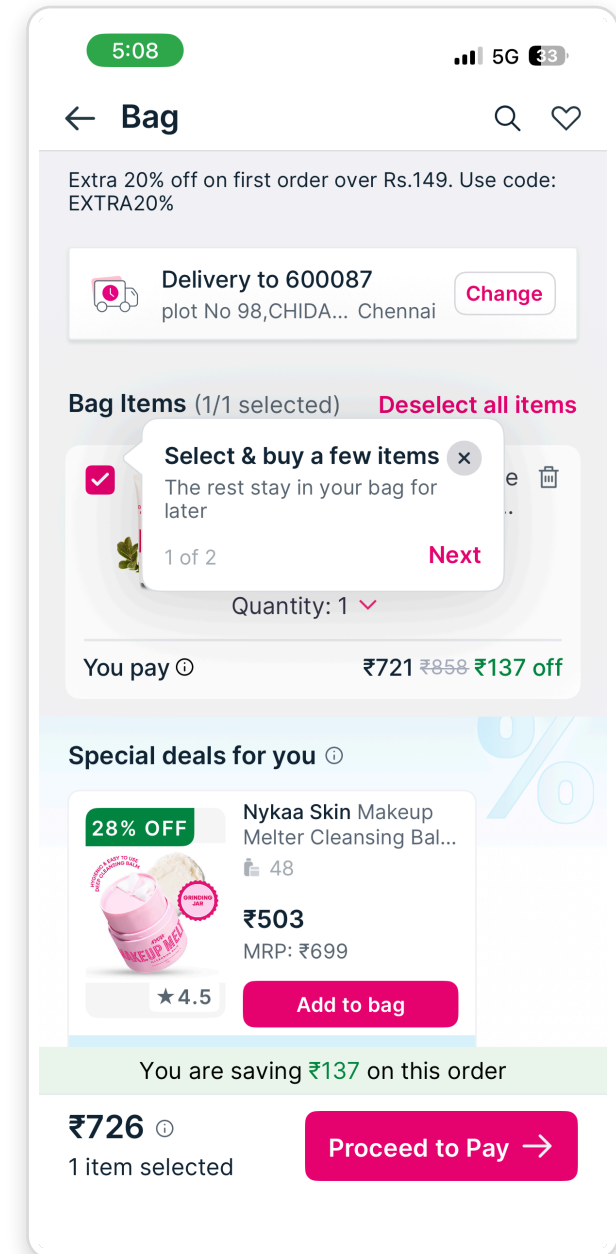
Beauty Portfolio — 100% complete, still doesn't filter reviews

Checkout Handles the Transactional Core Well

Once past discovery, the cart and checkout experience was a clear high point. Price breakdowns (base price, discount, final total), coupon application, and address confirmation were all immediate and legible. Order confirmation clearly stated delivery windows for both items in the order, and a WhatsApp tracking notification arrived within moments of placing the order.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This is the part of the app that most consistently earns trust — the actual money-and-delivery mechanics are handled cleanly, in sharp contrast to the discovery and research experience earlier in the journey.

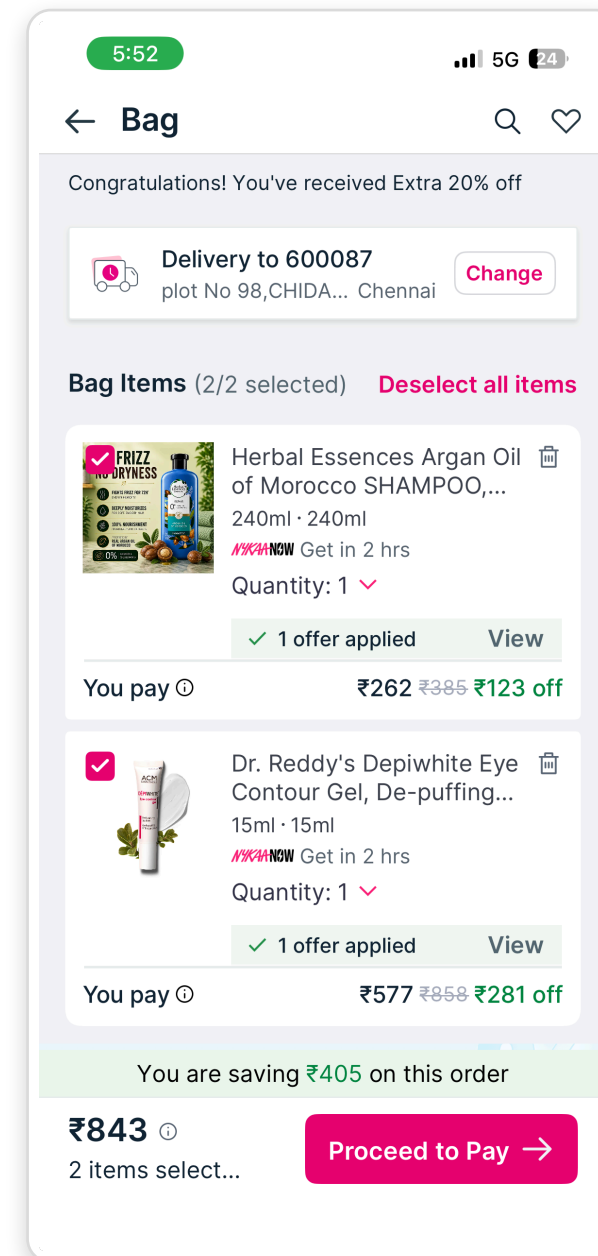


A Shipping Fee That Seems to Contradict Nykaa's Own Policy

Nykaa's own site advertises free shipping above ₹299. The order total was well past that threshold, yet a ₹5 shipping fee still applied — with no explanation in checkout. It was only after checking the order status that the fee's source became clear: it belonged to NykaaNow, a separate 2-hour quick-delivery fulfillment path with its own fee logic.

SUGGESTED FIX

Label which fulfillment mode (standard vs. NykaaNow) is being used at the point the fee appears in checkout — not several steps later — so the charge doesn't read as a broken promise.

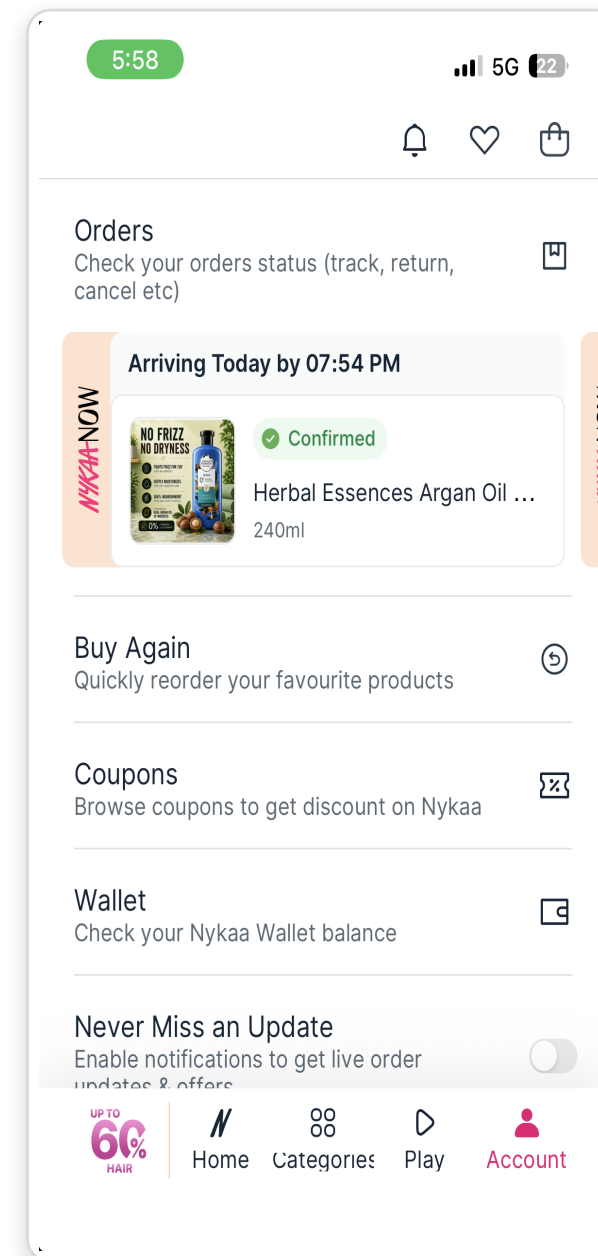


Too Many Parallel Programs, Not Enough Integration

The Account section stacks several separate systems together: Loyalty Program, Nykaa Pro, Beauty Portfolio, Wallet, and Coupons — each presented as its own item, with no visible relationship between them. Does Nykaa Pro include loyalty benefits? Does the Beauty Portfolio unlock anything in Nykaa Pro? Nothing in the UI answers this, so users are left to explore each system in isolation.

SUGGESTED FIX

Group related programs under a single “Your Nykaa” hub with a short explanation of how each piece connects, rather than presenting five parallel systems as unrelated menu items.



Account screen — Orders, Buy Again, Coupons, Wallet all stacked together



What Public Reviews Say

Cross-checked against Trustpilot and aggregated Play Store feedback to see if this session's friction reflects a broader pattern.

RECURRING NEGATIVE THEMES

- Delivery delays — some waits reported well beyond the promised window
- Return process friction — pickup cancellations, repeated follow-ups
- Price instability — prices reportedly rising while items sit in cart
- Product mismatch — items not matching what was shown online

RECURRING POSITIVE THEMES

- Product range and authenticity claims
- App simplicity and ease of browsing, when things go smoothly

Synthesis: this session's own findings and public sentiment point the same direction — Nykaa's pre-purchase experience (browsing, cart, checkout) is comparatively strong, but trust leaks most heavily post-purchase.

Three Feature Opinions

NEEDS IMPROVEMENT

Generic / concern-based search

Built to feel smart, but a bestseller product got buried under a broad query — undermining the feature's own premise.

POOR EXECUTION

Beauty Portfolio as a review filter

Looks like a fast filter but is actually an onboarding funnel for an unrelated social feature — and never solved the original task.

STRONG

Checkout price & delivery transparency

Pricing, discounts, and delivery confirmation were consistently clear and fast — this is where the app earns trust.

What Real Users Said

Two people outside product/design were asked about their Nykaa experience — likes, dislikes, and any reason they dropped off without buying.

INTERVIEWEE 1 — Swati, first-time app user

Normally: price-compares via Google/Amazon/Flipkart, no app loyalty

Liked: fast Google login, no forced preference questions, strong UI and review detail

Frustrated by: product page overload — wants details behind a card/expand, not all shown at once

Drop-off: reports she has never abandoned a Nykaa purchase partway through

INTERVIEWEE 2 — Returning user

Uses Nykaa for: []

Likes: []

Dislikes: []

Past drop-off, and why: []

Reflection

WHAT I USUALLY IGNORE

Small frictions — a forced notification prompt, a slow delivery estimate, a mismatched suggestion — are normally absorbed without conscious notice. Logging every step revealed how many small decisions a single task actually requires.

DID TALKING TO USERS CHANGE MY VIEW?

Partly. Swati never mentioned the app-fragmentation or Beauty Portfolio issues I flagged as major — she simply never went looking for reviews by skin type. Instead she surfaced something I'd walked right past: product-page information density. As someone less familiar with certain categories, she found detail dumped all at once overwhelming, where I (already knowing what I was looking for) read the same page as thorough. [Update further once interview 2 is in.]

WHAT WAS MOST CHALLENGING

Separating genuine usability problems (like the Beauty Portfolio detour, which actively failed to solve the task) from reasonable product complexity that simply takes a moment to learn.

Feature-Rich, Not Feature-Integrated

Two separate apps, a Beauty Portfolio that didn't solve the task, overlapping loyalty programs, and cross-promotion between sister apps — none of these is a dealbreaker alone. Together, they ask more of the user's attention than a simple task should require.

A single, simplified app would likely serve most users better than the current split-and-stack approach.